

Πολύστρατος ὁ Ἐπικούρειος

Polystratus the Epicurean on the Contempt of the Irrational

eul_aid: jss

Period: Ἑλληνιστική Hellenistic

Dialect: Κοινή Koine (phi, frg)

Domain: Φιλοσοφία Philosophy

Format: Πραγματεία Treatise

Affiliation: Epicurean

Polystratus was a Greek philosopher of the 3rd century BCE. He was a leading member of the Epicurean school, succeeding Hermarchus to become its third head, or scholarch, in Athens. In this role, he led the Epicurean community known as the Garden during its early, formative period.

While few details of his life are known, his importance comes from his leadership and his surviving writings. Two of his treatises exist in fragments: **On Irrational Contempt** and **On Philosophy**. These works show him defending core Epicurean teachings. In particular, **On Irrational Contempt** argues that common fears and popular opinions should not be dismissed irrationally but examined with reason, a key Epicurean idea.

According to modern scholars, Polystratus's primary significance was as an early defender of the school's orthodoxy. His writings provide a valuable window into how Epicurean philosophers, in the generation after the founder Epicurus, worked to explain and consolidate their doctrines against potential criticisms in the wider intellectual world.

Works (2)

- Ἀποσπάσματα περὶ Διώξεως τοῦ Ἀγαθοῦ · Fragments on the Pursuit of the Good · 25 passages
- Περὶ ἀλόγου καταφρονήσεως · On the Contempt of the Irrational · 56 passages

Other Epicurean Authors

- Καρνεῖσκος ὁ Ἐπικούρειος · Carneiscus the Epicurean · 2 works
- Διογένης ὁ Οἰνοανδεύς · Diogenes of Oenoanda · 1 work
- Ἀνώνυμος Ἐπικούρειος · Epicurean Anonymous · 2 works
- Ἐπίκουρος ὁ φιλόσοφος · Epicurus the Philosopher · 8 works
- Ἑρμαρχος ὁ Μυτιληναῖος · Hermarchus of Mytilene · 1 work
- Μητρόδωρος ὁ Λαμψακηνός · Metrodorus of Lampsacus the Elder · 1 work
- Φιλόδημος ὁ Γαδαρεύς · Philodemus of Gadara · 3 works